

Zemar Hakim

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Education

Queens's University

PhD, Economics

Candidate

Toronto Metropolitan University

MA, International Economics and Finance

Wilfrid Laurier University

BA, Honours Economics

Research and Policy Papers

Development, Environmental Economics, Causal Inference, Spatial Analysis, Machine Learning, Trade

Proximity to the Plague: Measuring Locust Exposure and Child Health

Wildfire smoke, air quality, and the limits of short-run labor-market impacts in Canadian cities

G7 Sanctions Matching Report

When It Never Rains: Index Insurance and the Resilience of Relational Contracts During Drought

Born into Drought: Early-Life Exposure and Child Health in Angola

Sanctions Price Adjustment and Deflators

Awards

Mac Urquhart PhD Award for best second-year paper in Economics (\$2,500)

2026

Economics Department Award (\$10,000 x 4)

2022-2026

E. Gay Mitchell Graduate Fellowship in Finance (\$8,000)

2024

Ontario Graduate Scholarship (\$15,000 x 2)

2020, 2022

Dean's List (\$1,500)

2018

Wilfrid Laurier Entrance Scholarship (\$15,000)

2015

Professional Experience

Senior Associate Summer Intern

Toronto, Ontario

Charles River Associates

2026

- Conducted quantitative and economic analysis for litigation, regulatory, and strategy engagements across multiple industries, synthesizing large datasets to support expert testimony and client recommendations.
- Built and maintained financial and econometric models in Excel, R, and Python to evaluate damages, market dynamics, and competitive effects, ensuring accuracy and reproducibility under tight deadlines.
- Conducted in-depth industry, market, and company research, translating findings into clear, client-ready reports and presentations for senior consultants and case teams.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams of economists, consultants, and data analysts to structure analyses, validate assumptions, and prepare deliverables for client meetings and regulatory submissions.
- Supported due diligence and case preparation by compiling data from public and proprietary sources, performing statistical analysis, and drafting summaries of key findings for senior stakeholders.

Senior Research Analyst (Consultant)

Ottawa, Ontario

Global Affairs Canada

2022-Present

- Designed and maintained automated data pipelines in R, Python, and SQL to clean, merge, and validate over 500 million trade and sanctions records from Statistics Canada, Canada Border Service Agency, and Canada Revenue Agency.
- Developed and implemented causal inference and machine learning models to quantify the economic impact of sanctions and conflicts, forecasting trade flows worth more than \$2 trillion annually and identifying

anomalous transaction patterns across G7 economies.

- Engineered data architecture in R integrating over 25,000 unique entities across G7 and FVEY jurisdictions, improving query performance by 40 percent and enabling experimentation and counterfactual analysis for ongoing policy evaluation.
- Built interactive dashboards for 3 government departments in Power BI and R, supporting over 20 ministerial briefings and multiple regulatory revisions within Global Affairs Canada's Sanctions Bureau.
- Collaborated with economists and policy teams to incorporate risk scoring, feature engineering, and experimental design into compliance workflows
- Managed 2 direct reports in data entry, Excel, reproducible R and Python pipelines, and model interpretation.

Economics Expert (Contract)

2026-Present

Mercor

- Developed AI training data for large language models by designing tasks related to development, macroeconomics, and econometrics, and authoring detailed solution rationales to support supervised fine-tuning and reinforcement learning pipelines
- Identified AI model failure modes in logic, numerical reasoning, and code generation, improving dataset coverage of edge cases critical for model robustness
- Collaborated to ensure consistency, calibration, and reproducibility across large-scale AI training datasets

Research Assistant

2020-Present

- Philippe Kabore: Data cleaning and analysis
- Cherie Metcalf: Data visualization and basic analysis
- Hyunju Lee: Literature Review

Teaching Assistant

2020-Present

- ECON 290: Energy Economics
- PPEC 200: Introduction to the Study of Politics, Philosophy and Economics
- ECON 110111/112: Head TA, Principles of Economics
- ECON 111: Head TA, Introductory Microeconomics
- ECON 112: Head TA, Introductory Macroeconomics
- ECON 430: Issues in Economic History
- ECON 831: Issues in North American Economic History
- ECN 606: International Monetary Economics

President and CEO

Waterloo, Ontario

Wilfrid Laurier University Students' Union

2019 – 2020

- Elected to represent over 17,000 students, managing an \$11 million budget to oversee operations, services, and advocacy efforts for the Students' Union.
- Managed a team of 5 direct reports, providing mentorship and guidance to support the successful delivery of goods, services and events.
- Acted as the first point of contact and representative for student advocacy for the institution, municipal, provincial and federal levels of government
- Created and led the university's first institutional committee on student basic needs, addressing food insecurity and housing challenges
- Responded to emerging crises, including navigating institutional changes and addressing student concerns during the early stages of the COVID-19 pandemic, ensuring continuity in services.

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: R, Python, SQL, Stata, MATLAB, ArcGIS, QGIS, PostGIS

Cloud and Collaboration: GitHub, MS Office (incl. Power BI), Google Suite (incl. GCP), AWS (S3, EC2), Jupyter, L^AT_EX, Google Earth Engine, Databricks

Languages: English, French, Urdu

Volunteering and Community Activity

Shepherds of Good Hope - Ottawa Homeless Service
Mississauga Food Bank

References

References available upon request